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Business management:

Even If You Have A **GOOD MACHINE** And **BAD SUPPORT**, It Is Still A **BAD MACHINE**

This interview shares some tips for managers and future business leaders, where we brief over acquisitions, team management and development. Mark Norris, general manager - SE Asia and Korea, Nordson Advanced Technologies Electronic Systems speaks with Dilin Anand of EFY

Q. How do you improve your technologies after an acquisition?

A. A very good example is that, in September this year (2015), we announced the acquisition of a company called Matrix, in Germany. When we approached Matrix, we quickly realised that while we were extremely strong in the handling of the substrate, they were really good at inspection and usage of certain algorithms to recognise defects. They also used software to interpret results and give these to the operator.

Our strength with offline x-ray is in terms of tube technology and detector technology. When we came to know about this, we immediately set up a plan with the company to take our combined strengths and do a classic 'one plus one equals three.'

Q. What should be kept in mind when considering acquisitions?

A. For us, it is really about acquiring companies that are complementary to what we already have. This enables us to share R&D re-

sources and to implement sales and support through the existing sales structure of the parent company.

Q. What is a good business mantra in your line of business?

A. I always say that even if you have a good machine and bad support, it is still a bad machine. This is because a good machine lets people do their work and if they are waiting for the support team to fix a problem, the good machine just goes bad. So the ideal solution is